

No Proof $\rightarrow$ No Belief

If you can't give a good argument for P, don't believe P.

Doubt $\rightarrow$ No Belief

If you cannot distinguish between a situation in which P and a situation in which not-P, do not believe P.

Proof $\rightarrow$ Belief

If you can prove P,
believe P.

Let's take stock. We've now considered three candidate rules of belief.

We've seen that both of our "no belief" principles are open to substantial challenge. But surely, one might think, there must be **some** principle which explains why certain beliefs are bad beliefs.

Pastafarianism has its uses. For example, it can be used to get a religious exemption from the rule that one cannot wear a hat in a driver's license photo:

Arizona

DRIVER LICENSE

USA

NOT FOR FEDERAL IDENTIFICATION



9 CLASS D

9e END M

12 REST NONE

1 CORBETT

2 SEAN MICHAEL

8

4b EXP [REDACTED]/2045

15 SEX M

18 EYES HAZ

16 HGT 5'-07" 19 HAIR BRO

17 WGT 250 lb

DONOR ♥

4d DLN [REDACTED]

3 DOB [REDACTED]/1980



4a ISS 05/04/2017

[REDACTED]/80

Sean Michael Corbett

As you might guess, many Pastafarians take a somewhat less than serious attitude toward the tenets of Pastafarianism. But it can be used to make a serious philosophical point.

Suppose that someone were a serious Pastafarian. We would, I take it, be inclined to think that there is something irrational about their beliefs.

And this might be so even if we could not come up with any decisive argument against Pastafarianism. After all, Pastafarianism is designed so as to avoid arguments against it. When presented with such an argument, the Pastafarian will simply say that the evidence on which the argument is based is misleading, and was planted by the Flying Spaghetti Monster.

So why is the religious believer who believes without arguments any better
than the Pastafarian?

Last time we introduced the question of what we should believe. We began by

considering this rule of belief:























IN















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Don't → No Belief

If you're not distinguishing

in which not- P , do not

best weather situation in

DeLiave IR.

which is a situation



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all, which seems very implausible.

But we saw that this led to the result that you should not believe anything at

At the very least, it seems, we should believe things that we can be certain of:



















IN















IN



B

















































































